dining room at Headingley. I don't mind. I don't enjoy being the centre of controversy, but I wasn't sure and that's the fact.

Kevin Pietersen cracks a quick 45 during the afternoon, but our fast bowlers soon regain control and England are dismissed for 203 in only 52 overs and three balls. Dale and Morné each take four, Makhaya and Jacques take one. Make no mistake, when this quartet of fast bowlers is firing, we look an exceptionally strong team.

## Saturday, 19 July 2008

The spectators are booing me – and it's not just one or two people expressing mild displeasure as I walk out to bat in our first innings at Headingley. It feels like each and every one of the 8 000 supporters sitting on the Western Terrace are booing me, all of them reacting to the grounded-catch furore of the previous day.

No problem, I tell myself. I'll show them what I can do.

I take guard and prepare to face my first ball. Darren Pattinson, on his debut, is running in and bowls a perfect out-swinger. I play defensively and miss. The crowd roars. The breadth of a hair is all that stands between me surviving to continue my innings and me getting a tiny edge, being caught behind, being out for a golden duck and being mocked all the way back to the pavilion by a boisterous capacity crowd eager to see me punished.

Mercifully, I survive. Our total is 143 for four. Ashwell Prince is batting beautifully again and, together, we start to build the partnership that we need to consolidate our position. It's very hard work. Jimmy Anderson is showing why he is widely rated as one of the outstanding bowlers in the world, beating me several times. I am struggling and scratching around and, inevitably, I receive abuse from the fielders every time I play and miss.

Bring it on, I think. I keep battling, determined not to give anything away.